

STORY COMPLETION

A guide for young writers.

What is Story Completion?

Story completion is a super fun and creative way to build your storytelling skills! Instead of starting a story from scratch, you're given the beginning of a story and your job is to finish it. Think of it like being a detective who has found a mysterious clue and needs to figure out the rest of the puzzle.

It's a fantastic way to:

- **Boost your creativity:** You'll come up with new characters, exciting plots, and surprising twists!
- **Develop your writing skills:** You'll practice describing things, writing dialogue, and making your stories flow.
- **Learn about story structure:** You'll see how a beginning, middle, and end work together to make a great story.
- **Explore different ideas:** You can experiment with different genres, like fantasy, mystery, sci-fi, or adventure.

Why is Story Completion Great for You?

Sometimes, staring at a blank page can be a little intimidating. Story completion gives you a helpful starting point, so you can jump right into the action and focus on what happens next. It's like having a recipe for a cake, you just need to add your own special ingredients and decorations!

This exercise is perfect for imagining all sorts of possibilities. What if the character finds a hidden map? What if a strange creature appears? What if there's a secret message? Your imagination is the only limit!

It helps you think outside the box and come up with unexpected endings. You'll learn how to build suspense, create compelling characters, and make your readers eager to know what happens next. Plus, it's a great way to see how different people can take the same beginning and create completely different, amazing stories!

Let's Get Creative: Your Story Completion Challenge!

Here's the beginning of a story. Read it carefully, then use your amazing imagination to finish it! What happens next? Who do they meet? What do they discover? Have fun with it!

The Beginning:

Elara stumbled upon an old, dusty map tucked away in the attic. It wasn't like any map she'd ever seen before. Strange symbols were drawn along the edges, and in the center, a shimmering island was marked with a single, glowing 'X'. A faint hum seemed to emanate from the parchment, and as her fingers traced the outline of the island, the air around her grew warm and a faint scent of saltwater filled the room. She felt an undeniable pull, a whisper in her mind urging her to seek out this mysterious place. Clutching the map, she knew her ordinary summer had just taken an extraordinary turn...

Your Turn!

- **What does Elara do next?** Does she pack a bag? Does she tell anyone? Does she try to decipher the symbols?
- **How does she get to the island?** Does she find a secret portal? Does she build a raft? Does she get help from an unexpected source?
- **What is on the island?** Is it an ancient ruin? A hidden treasure? A magical creature's home?
- **What challenges does Elara face?** Are there puzzles to solve? Dangers to overcome? Moral dilemmas?
- **What is the 'X' marking?** What does she find there?
- **How does her adventure end?** Does she return home? Does she stay on the island? Does she learn something important about herself?

Write your own ending to Elara's story below!

Next Steps

Now that you've finished Elara's story, here are a few ideas:

- **Read your story aloud:** Hearing your words can help you catch awkward sentences or parts that could be more exciting.
- **Share your story:** Show it to a friend, family member, or teacher. Getting feedback can help you improve your writing.
- **Try another starting point:** Look for other story completion prompts online or in books, and keep practicing!
- **Illustrate your story:** Draw pictures to go along with your amazing adventure.
- **Turn it into a comic:** Turn your completed story into a comic strip or graphic novel!